CLUB DE POLITICA EXTERIOR Y DIPLOMACIA

MODEL UNITED NATIONS SIMULATION RULES OF PROCEDURE

Document that explains in detail how the Model UN procedure is conducted, which includes:

Glossary

a. **Simple Majority:** Refers to the decision adopted when the number of votes in favor must be 50% of the chamber plus one, so that the motion can be approved.

b. **Qualified Majority:** Requires a higher percentage, for example, two-thirds of the votes, meaning it must exceed 66.67% or ¾ of the chamber's votes in favor for the motion or resolution to be approved.

c. **Point of Information:** Delegates may ask questions or request clarification exclusively from the Chair in order to resolve doubts. Example: "Point of information to the Chair: The delegation of Russia would like to know how much time remains until the end of the debate."

d. **Point of Order:** Delegates may use a point of order to signal a violation of the rules of procedure to the Chair. Example: "Point of order to the Chair: the delegation of China has not requested permission to open a brief preamble before asking their question."

e. **Point of Parliamentary Inquiry:** Point used to indicate to the Chair that parliamentary procedure was not carried out correctly.

f. **Point of Personal Privilege:** Point used to indicate to the Chair that there are serious allegations or fallacies that another delegation is making against the delegation being represented. The Chair may be asked to request that the other delegation provide evidence for their arguments.

   i. **Right of Reply:** Used to counter-argue accusations that were previously made.

   ii. **Right of Second Reply:** Space for the opposing party to argue against the defense of the accused delegation.

g. **Sponsor Country:** One or more countries that present or propose a draft resolution.

h. **Co-sponsor Country:** Countries that support and back the draft resolution proposed by the sponsors.

All points or motions must be addressed exclusively to the Chair; there can be no communication toward other delegates, this is known as triangular conversation.

Parliamentary Language:

Parliamentary language is the form of expression that delegates and the Dais must use in their interventions. The delegate must always speak in the third person singular, to ensure they represent the country and its interests, not their own point of view. In debate, the

third person is always used, for example: *"this delegation requests that the delegate of the People's Republic of China..."*

Never speak in first person: "I request that the delegation of China..."

POSITION PAPER

The position paper is the initial document where a country's stance on the topic(s) to be discussed in the committee is described. It consists of:

- Personally designed cover page
- A letter addressed to the Chair
- Introduction with general country information (Situational Analysis)
- Country's stance on the topics
- Solutions to the issues provided (possible answers to Handbook questions)
- Bibliography

The length of the essay will be at the discretion of the organizing committee or Chair, where an introduction and the country's stance on each agenda item will be reflected. Within this document, speaking in first person should be avoided.

MOTIONS

A motion is a request submitted by a delegate to the chamber by raising their placard. It involves requesting authorization from the Dais for a specific action. In each committee,

formal debate occurs, and to organize delegate participation, motions are used, which will be subject to a voting process. Any delegate may raise their placard and mention the motion they deem appropriate. Next, the Chair asks: "Delegations that second the motion." If the motion is approved, it is carried out; otherwise, another delegation may propose another motion and submit it to vote again. *It should be clarified that the delegation that motions and is recognized by the Chair will be the first to participate in the procedure they have stipulated.*

Seconding a motion: It is a procedural act following the motion raised, consisting of supporting that a motion be considered and submitted to vote by the committee. It is understood that if the delegate seconds a motion, they will vote in favor of it, and will indicate that the motion should be considered for discussion. If the motion is not seconded, it will not pass and will not be submitted to vote. It is a procedural requirement for an idea to advance, not a vote on its content. *It should be clarified that the delegation that seconds the motion and is recognized by the Chair will be the second to participate in the procedure they have stipulated.*

Voting in favor of a motion: It is the substantial and definitive decision to support a document or proposal in the final vote. By voting in favor, the delegate expresses their agreement with the content and their desire for it to be officially approved.

Voting against a motion: It is the decision not to support the document or proposal submitted to vote, showing that the delegate does not wish it to be approved.

1. **Initial Procedural Motions**

These motions must be used in the following order:

a. **Motion to open session:** To open session, any delegation must raise their placard, stand up, and say: *"Motion to open session"*, this motion will be seconded and proceed to the corresponding voting process.

- Next, the Chair will proceed to take roll call. When the delegate hears their country's name, they stand up and report their status by saying *"present"* or *"present and voting"*.
- **Present:** The delegate may abstain from voting for or against the draft resolutions presented in formal session.
- **Present and Voting:** The delegate must decide whether they are in favor or against the draft resolutions in formal session.
- The Chair may declare the session of an organ or committee open once at least two-thirds of the representatives are present in the chamber.

b. **Motion to set the agenda/order of the day:** *This motion is used exclusively in debates where more than one topic is specified for discussion.* As soon as the Dais declares the session open, a motion will be made to establish the agenda, which may be made by any delegate, who must raise their placard, stand up, and say: *"Motion to set the agenda."* The Chair will ask *"under what agenda"* here the delegation will state *"Topic 1-2 or Topic 2-1"*.

c. **Motion to open the speakers list**: Once the order of the agenda is established, a speakers list will be opened to begin debate on the first topic determined. Any delegation may raise their placard and say: *"Motion to open the speakers list,"* once the motion is accepted. The Chair asks the chamber who wishes to be added to this speakers list, and the order is established based on who raised their placard. The delegate who made the motion is the first to come forward and present their position.

General considerations about the speakers list:

1. Adding oneself to the speakers list **is not mandatory**. Each delegation can decide whether they wish to intervene in this phase or not.
2. Delegations that do not sign up when the list is opened may do so later by sending a note via *note (pager)* to the Chair. In this case, the delegation will be added to the end of the list, respecting the previously established order.
3. At the Chair's discretion, the speakers list may be altered.

d. **Motion for a question and answer period:** This motion will only be considered when the delegation has finished explaining their position within the Speakers List. The delegate may raise their placard and say: *"Motion for a question and answer period"*, The delegation that requested the motion may establish the number of questions to be asked of the speaker at the podium, or could mention that the number of questions be determined at the Chair's discretion.

Once the delegation requesting the motion establishes the number of questions to be asked, the Chair must ask the speaker whether they accept or not to receive questions. If the speaker does not accept, the motion will be automatically rejected. If the speaker accepts, the Chair asks the chamber which delegations second the motion, then whether they are in favor or against it; the delegations that second it will be recognized to ask questions.

i. **Permission for brief preamble:** "Permission for a brief preamble" may be used before asking the question, where the delegation will contextualize the topic or show the underlying reasons motivating the inquiry. No type of preamble or argumentative burden will be allowed if not requested from the Chair. The time to do so is 15 seconds. If no preamble is required, only the specific question should be asked to the delegation at the podium, thus omitting the verbal request to the Chair. Once the delegate at the podium answers the question, the Chair will ask the delegation if their question has been answered. They must respond affirmatively if satisfied with the answer; otherwise, they must respond "No, Chair" or "Partially, Chair," which will be understood as the delegate wishing to ask a follow-up question; however, it is not mandatory to ask it.

ii. **Right to follow-up question:** The delegate who asked the question may request a follow-up question if they consider the initial answer did not address all points or needs more detail. To do so, they must request the "right to a follow-up question." This right is only granted when the additional question is directly related to the answer received and seeks to clarify it. The use of the right to a follow-up question is not permitted to pose a completely new question, address a different topic, and no preamble can be made; in such case, a new concrete question must be formulated.

2. **Debate Motions**

These motions may be requested when at least three opening interventions have occurred in the speakers list, but it will be completely at the Chair's discretion. Subsequently, they may be requested randomly during the course of the committee. They will be used to propose different debate modalities within the session. The Chair may deny, accept, or submit the matter to vote; each and every one will require a simple majority. The motions are as follows:

a. **Motion for a moderated caucus:** The purpose of the moderated caucus is to energize debate, to achieve more direct dialogue among delegates, in an organized manner and according to the needs of the problem being addressed in each Committee. The delegate may raise their placard and say: *"Motion for a*

moderated caucus." The Chair will ask the committee if there is any other delegation that seconds the motion, then it will proceed to vote.

Once the motion is approved, the maximum duration of the moderated caucus will be defined by the delegate or by the Chair as the case may be, but the time range of the debate in general, as well as the speaking time for each delegation, will be established by the delegate who proposed the motion or at the Chair's discretion. During the moderated caucus, each delegate must raise their placard to be recognized and may present their position on the topic.

b. **Motion for a delegation-moderated caucus**

The main purpose of this motion is for a specific delegation to use the time for a specific purpose. The Chair will ask the reason for the Motion and the delegation must respond with a weighty reason; if the Chair does not consider it a sufficient reason, the motion simply does not pass. Outside of those conditions, the motion maintains the same nature as the *"Motion for a moderated caucus"* but the moderator during that debate time is the delegation that motioned.

3. **Caucus**

It is an informal session that allows delegates to discuss specific topics in a more flexible and dynamic way than in a formal debate.

a. **Unmoderated caucus:** The unmoderated caucus consists of interaction among delegates without moderation from the Dais. Its objectives are: to grant delegates

a space for negotiation and matters to address, to provide delegates with a communicational space so they can analyze and share proposals to develop a draft resolution or decision. The unmoderated caucus must be proposed by motion by the delegation interested in it. The delegate may raise their placard and say: *"Motion for an unmoderated caucus,"* and it must be accepted by a simple majority; upon conclusion, the delegate who motioned for the caucus must inform the Dais of its result. The duration of the unmoderated caucus will be defined by the Chair with the option to extend it through a subsequent motion.

4. Motions to extend moderated caucus:

Any delegate may motion to extend the motions for "question and answer period," "moderated caucus or delegation-moderated caucus," or "unmoderated caucus." None of the extensions can exceed or equal in time or quantity the original motion. For example, if an unmoderated caucus motion lasted 10 minutes, its extension must be less than 10 minutes. Or if originally the question and answer period is 4 questions, the extension must be 3 or fewer.

Once the debate time or questions to the delegate at the podium has concluded, a motion may be made to extend, raising their placard and saying "Motion to extend (pertinent motion)." However, the Chair may ask the reason for requesting an extension and the delegate must explain the reason for the motion. The motion is approved if the other delegates are in favor of it.

5. **Formal Session**

Formal session takes place when draft resolutions have been sent and approved by the Chair. Once initiated, roll call will be taken again. During this process, each delegation may respond "present" or "present and voting." Delegations that indicate "present and voting" may not abstain in votes taken during formal session; conversely, delegations that indicate "present" may abstain from voting.

Subsequently, the draft resolutions will be read in order of arrival, where sponsor countries are those who read the project. Following the reading of each project, the motions in order are motion for adoption by acclamation and motion to table the draft resolution. If neither of these motions passes, then the project will only pass if it has an absolute majority of votes.

a. **Motion to open formal session:** When it is considered that solutions have been reached within the committee, any delegate may raise their placard and say *"Motion to open formal session."* Once the motion is approved, all delegates must put away their electronic devices such as laptops, cell phones, iPads, among others, and maintain the formality of the event. Only the sponsors of the draft resolutions may use electronic devices when presenting their drafts that have been previously approved by the Chair.

6. **Motion for adoption by acclamation**

After the draft resolution is presented, any delegation may make this motion, meaning the entire committee supports that resolution, and therefore it will be approved unanimously. The Chair will ask "is there any delegation that is not in favor," to which, if any other delegation raises their placard, showing they are against it, then the draft resolution does not pass unanimously.

If this second case occurs, ***speaking time against and speaking time in favor*** will be granted, in that order. The Chair will allocate a period for each, with speaking time in favor being the first to occur. In this space, any delegation by raising their placard may defend their position regarding the project when the Chair grants them the floor. The Chair has the authority to absorb the time if deemed pertinent. Only during this time is it in order to make and send amendments to the Chair.

Once speaking time in favor and against has concluded, no more amendments are received, and the appropriate motion is "Motion for consideration of amendments."

7. Motion for consideration of amendments

During the motion, all amendments received will be read in order of arrival. They may be amendments of form (grammatical corrections, e.g., periods, commas, spelling errors) or substantive amendments (those that change some operative factor of the project). After reading each amendment, the Chair will ask the sponsor and co-sponsor delegations if they consider it a friendly amendment or unfriendly amendment. If declared friendly, the amendment passes; if unfriendly, then there will be speaking time against and in favor

with a time the Chair deems appropriate, subsequently it will be submitted to a vote by simple majority and every delegation must vote.

No sponsor or co-sponsor delegation may make amendments to their own project, unlike signatory delegations who may. Every amendment must not have ambiguities, must be written clearly and in detail, and include location references (Line number or article).

Amendments may be rejected by the Chair for the following reasons:

- When they have ambiguities.
- When there is an amendment to an approved amendment (amendment upon amendment).
- When they are outside the speaking time in favor or against the draft. When they do not comply with the required structure or formal wording, that is, when they do not express clearly, precisely, and coherently the proposed modification, or include vague terms, suggestions, or formulations that do not correspond to the established amendment format.

8. Motion to vote by placards

It is the motion to conduct a public vote, where each delegation raises their identifying placard to show their vote (In Favor, Against, Abstention) before the entire committee.

9. Motion to vote by roll call

Used so that the Dais calls roll to all delegations, who, when named, must declare whether they are in favor or against. If "only present," the delegation may abstain.

10. Motion to table the draft resolution

The motion to table draft resolutions may be presented only after the formal reading of the project before the committee. To be approved, it must have the favorable vote of three-quarters (¾) of the chamber. This motion aims to express that the draft resolution is not accepted by the international community, so if approved, the project will be rejected by default and will not be submitted to debate. The proposing delegation will have a time, determined by the Chair, to substantiate the reasons for the motion.

11. Motion to suspend formal session:

Used only when all projects have been addressed, it is the step prior to the motion to close session

12. Motion to suspend session

This Motion will be presented when, for reasons of schedule or direction's disposition, it is necessary to temporarily suspend the Session, having to reinstate the session on the same day. Any delegate may motion to suspend the session, raising their placard and saying *"Motion to suspend session."* The Chair must ask for the suspension time of the session and will submit the motion to vote, requiring approval by simple majority.

13. Motion to resume session:

It is a procedural motion used to reopen the session when it was temporarily suspended.

14. Motion to close session

This motion will be presented to definitively close the debate days of the Model. Any delegate may motion, raising their placard and saying *"Motion to close session."* The Chair will submit the motion to vote, requiring approval by simple majority.

i. **Amendments:** Used exclusively to make modifications to a draft resolution. Must be submitted in writing to the Chair specifying which article and/or clause should be modified. May request elimination, modification, or addition of text; however, the new text or modified text must be transcribed as desired for the amendment to be accepted.

   Example of draft resolution article:

   To establish *a "Rapid Action Program for Implementation and Analysis of Funds for Financial Assistance" within a period of 1 year. Amendment from the Republic of Ecuador:*

   Modify clause "i" to: To establish a "Rapid Action Program for Implementation and Analysis of Funds for Financial Assistance" within a period of ***2 years****.*

Sponsors must analyze the amendment and consider it as a friendly or unfriendly amendment.

Friendly amendment: All sponsors agree with the modification, does not require voting.

Unfriendly amendment: If any of the sponsors do not agree with the possible modification to the draft, debate will open and it will proceed to vote.